Green

Balance · heart · renewal

When you see it in branches, in grass or on a leaf, the body almost never resists it. It sits in the middle of the rainbow and somehow balances everything. And yet it can be treacherous. The same green means calm to one of us, envy, nausea or a school blackboard to another.

This page does not tell you what green means. **It shows it to you from several sides**. How it is mixed, how you paint with it, where its strength comes from, how it is read in different cultures and **what it can awaken in us**.

Contents

1. How to mix the colour and its shades 2

2. Rainbow – the chakra system 5

3. Free painting – intuition 8

4. Associations and stories 12

5. Emotions and feelings 14

6. Green in cultures and traditions 17

7. Colour frequency and phototherapy 27

8. Astrotype and colours 29

9. Colour for your website and business 48

10. Different colour combinations 52

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How to mix the colour and its shades

In painting, green is made by mixing yellow and blue. **The result, however, depends on the particular colours.** Two different blues with the same yellow can make quite different greens. A warmer blue with a hint of green is usually easier for a fresh mix than a blue with a strongly violet tint. The proportions are approximate and every brand behaves a little differently, so try them out on paper first.

What to prepare



Yellow

Brings a lighter, yellower and more springlike form of green.



Blue

Pushes it towards a cooler, deeper and bluer green.



White

Lightens it and creates mint and pastel tones.



Red

Its opposite on the colour wheel, in a small amount it calms green.



Brown

Helps with olive, moss and earthy shades.



Ochre

Gentler earthy tones, suitable for olive and khaki.

How can you recognise it without technical names?

A yellower green may recall freshly mown grass or lime, a bluer one a pine forest or sea water. The names on tubes differ between makers, so put **small samples** side by side and **add white** to part of them. You will then see the tint better.

On the tube look for the marking **PG** (Pigment Green) and a number. It tells you which pigment it is, even when the name differs. In green mixtures you will often also see **PY** and **PB**, that is the yellow and blue pigments the colour is mixed from.

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What the additions do



White

Lightens and pushes towards mint and pastel. Add it little by little.





Yellow

Leads to fresh, springlike and yellow-green tones.





Blue

Leads to blue-green, emerald and bottle green. A strong blue, add it carefully.





Red

Mutes it. A bigger dose pulls it towards brown-green and grey-green.





Brown

Earthy, forest tones. Moss and bark.





Ochre

Gentler earthy tones, olive and khaki.



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Ten greens to try

A part can be a drop, or a pile of paint of the same size. **Take the proportions as a starting point for trying things out**, not as a recipe for a cake.

Basic green

2 parts yellow + 1 part blue. Balanced, natural. Add the blue in small portions, it easily takes over.

Lime

4 parts lemon yellow + blue on the tip of the brush. Juicy, fresh, cheeky.

Spring yellow-green

1 part basic green + 1 part yellow, a little white if needed. Young leaves, the first spring.

Grass green

2 parts basic green + 1 part yellow. A meadow after rain. If it is too yellow, bring it back with a tiny trace of blue.

Bottle green

3 parts basic green + about 1 part dark blue. Deep, calm. A strong phthalo blue may need only the tip of the brush.

Olive

2 parts yellow ochre + a small amount of green, gradually. Earthy, warm. If it is too lively, try a dot of red.

Khaki

Start with olive and add a little brown, or white if you like. Brown grounds it, white lightens it.

Sage

3 parts white + 1 part green + a really small dot of red. Red mutes the saturation, try it first on the edge of the palette.

Mint

4 parts white + 1 part green + a dot of blue. Cool, fresh. Blue quickly pushes it towards turquoise.

Blue-green

2 parts basic green + gradually up to 1 part blue. If the blue is too strong, much less will do.

Light sea green

3 parts white + 1 part blue-green. Clean, airy. A drop of yellow brings it back to greener.

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Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of seven colours **green stands between yellow and blue**. In the rainbow map of the chakras it is **the fourth** and belongs to the **heart chakra**. You can imagine it as a place for **closeness**, **compassion** and your relationship with yourself and with others.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root

Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. Do I have something to lean on? What gives me a sense of safety right now?



Orange · sacral

Experiencing, pleasure, creating. Ask yourself. What does me good? Where do I allow myself joy?



Yellow · solar plexus

Self-worth, will. Ask yourself. What do I want? Where do I need to stand up for myself?



Green · heart

Closeness, relationships. Ask yourself. How am I with myself? Whom do I let close?



Blue · throat

Voice, expression. Ask yourself. What do I need to say? What do I no longer want to swallow?



Indigo · third eye

Inner vision, intuition. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown

Meaning, transcendence, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me meaning? What do I feel connected to?

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Anahata, the heart chakra

The chakras come from the Indian yogic and tantric tradition. The heart chakra is called Anahata (from Sanskrit “unstruck”, like a sound that arises without a strike). It sits in the middle of the chest. The element air, the seed syllable **YAM** and a lotus with twelve petals belong to it. Green is linked with it mainly in today's version, while in some traditional depictions another colour is given, for example vermilion.

Its theme is **love**, **compassion**, **forgiveness** and connection with others. For women this often turns into questions. Can I both give and receive? Do I have room in my heart for myself too?

When the chakra is open. You can give and receive, forgive others and yourself, and you do not have to protect yourself all the time. You feel that your place in close relationships is **safe**.

When the chakra is closed. The tradition describes closing off, coldness, loneliness and trouble trusting. Or the opposite. You give and give and then you have nothing. Closed does not mean bad. It is only a signal that you need more closeness, whether to others or to yourself.

When the heart chakra is said to be closed, what is usually meant is **withdrawal**. It is hard to trust someone, accept kindness or show vulnerability. Such an experience has many possible causes and it is not a chakra test.

How to add green when closeness is missing

- **Wear it**
  A green scarf, jumper or necklace near the chest. Something you can keep close to the body.
- **Put it in your home**
  A houseplant, herbs on the windowsill or a cushion. Something alive that you can care for.
- **Eat it**
  Leafy vegetables, herbs, green tea. Slowly and calmly.
- **Head out into nature**
  A walk in a forest or park and a moment by a tree, without your phone.
- **Paint it**
  Soft green circles in the lower part of the paper, with no goal and no judging.
- **Give yourself a small thing**
  A green pencil, notebook or mug of tea just for pleasure.

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When and how to add green when you give too much of yourself

When you have looked after others for a long time and hardly at all after yourself, you do not need more green care, but **boundaries** and tenderness for yourself.

- **Add red**
  In a small dose, as a scarf or lipstick. It is the colour of boundaries and strength.
- **Add pink**
  Powder pink as the colour of self-care. A blanket, bed linen, a candle.
- **Add brown**
  Support and stability. A wooden table, natural materials.
- **Add cream**
  A soft and calm base. Linen, cotton, light bedding.

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. Try gently and notice how you actually feel afterwards.

Picture it with an example

You look after everyone. You cook, shop, listen, remember who likes what. Everyone around you is a little more content, only in you, in the quiet of the evening, nothing stirs. Nothing important is collapsing. It is just that the moment when someone looks after you has slipped out of your days.

This is exactly where green can get its personal meaning. **Care can lead to you too**. You can give and receive at the same time, and also allow yourself to say “not today”.

Next to green other colours can feel fresher. Yellow makes it glow, blue quietens it and brown reminds you of the soil under the leaves. **These are possibilities of a personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a combination of colours.

How to use this map

It is a way of sorting out the themes you are living through. Do you add green because you miss closeness and care for yourself? Or do you put it aside because you have given too much? **You choose the meaning.** An added colour does not diagnose your state.

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Free painting – intuition

When we paint freely, with no goal and no effort at a pretty picture, **green** often appears at a moment when we want to **calm** something, let something **grow** or simply **rest** for a while. **The hand reaches for it before the brain can call a meeting**. Sometimes we know exactly why, sometimes not at all. **Both are fine**.

What may hide behind a green stroke

The same green line on paper can mean **something completely different every time**, depending on what is happening in us just then. Sometimes it is **calm**, sometimes **envy**, sometimes simply the taste of the colour. That is why there is no point in reading a picture like a test with **a single right answer**.

Longing for calm and a breath.

The stroke tends to be long, flowing and horizontal, like a meadow. The green is spilled out and nothing pushes it onward.

A need to grow and begin again.

The stroke heads upward, like stems and leaves. The colour spreads across the paper and claims space.

Caring for others.

Small regular strokes, like rows in a flower bed. Often around something or someone in the middle.

Envy and comparing.

A sharp, sour green, a narrow stroke, often next to another colour that it presses against and will not let go.

Tiredness and stagnation.

A matt grey-green, areas that do not change, a stroke that stops in the middle of the paper.

Nausea and oversaturation.

A yellow-green, unpleasant, sometimes even "green as bile". Like when you have had more than enough of something.

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Green in a picture. Can it express what is happening inside?

Yes, **it can**, but it does not have to. When painting you sometimes reach for a colour before you can name what you feel. Green can then give form to a longing for calm, growth or care, but also to envy or a feeling that you have had enough.

It can just as well be simply **a pretty colour** that you happened to have at hand that day. It gains meaning only in connection with your experience. A colour itself does not know what happened to you. **You do, or you will find out in time**.

Art therapy also works with the idea that a picture can express something for which words are hard to find. What matters is not a single patch of colour but **the whole picture** and how it came to be. Your situation, memories, the movement of your hand and your feelings while painting.

A predominance of green alone is not enough for a verdict on whether it is calm or tiredness. Maybe you wanted to rest. Maybe you simply enjoyed green so much that red had no chance that day.

I want it on the canvas, but I don't dare put it on myself

A green picture and a green jumper may ask two completely different things of you. On canvas you give space to an experience. In clothing you may feel that the colour connects you with something that does not belong to you. **The canvas can carry everything you need to say in it**, and you do not have to buy anything new for that.

On canvas you can give it enormous space and you do not have to accept at the same time the idea of how you yourself will look in it. **Canvas can be a safe place** where you allow expression in your own way.

Sometimes you want to wear it, sometimes just paint it. Sometimes you enjoy pine needles on the windowsill and would not take a green jumper even as a raffle prize. **The two do not exclude each other**.

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When green takes over the space

First let it come. Maybe you reach for green and have no idea why. Let it appear on the canvas without any duty to explain whether it is calm, tiredness, envy or a memory of grandmother's garden. You can paint standing, on the floor, with your hand, a brush or a piece of cloth. What matters is what happens to you as you spread the colour, layer it or let it take up more room.

Three things worth noticing

- **QUANTITY**

A little leaf, or a whole forest?

A small green trace can be the centre of the whole picture for you. A large area can feel calm and spacious, or start to be too heavy. A large green area is not proof of great calm and a small trace does not mean you cannot rest.

- **SATURATION**

Saturated, or gentle?

A pure green can have the look of freshly washed grass. With white it turns into a soft sage or mint. With ochre or brown it gets closer to moss, bark or olives. If relief floods you after adding white, it is precisely that change that is interesting. Perhaps a less urgent look suits you today.

- **THICKNESS**

What does it feel like under your hands?

Thick paint you can push, spread and leave a trace in. Thin paint spreads, runs and can surprise you with a direction you did not plan. One time the substance and resistance please you, another time the chance to let go of control and watch what happens. It is not a test of courage.

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What to take from the picture

It does not matter how the green stroke looks. More important is what you feel while making it, what situation you are in and what is happening in your life. **Two almost identical pictures can have a completely different story**. One was made after a long exhaustion, the other after the first spring day. That is why you will not find a dictionary here, but **questions**.

A picture can speak even after time

Perhaps after a while you will notice that you kept coming back to green in a period when you were missing **calm**, **space** or the wish to begin again. Perhaps you will link it with a completely different experience. In self-reflective work inspired by art therapy a picture can serve as **a trace of your own experience** and a chance to look back.

Answers often do not come right away

Sometimes you look at a picture and it tells you nothing at all. And in a week, a month or a year it suddenly comes: “Aha, this is what I was carrying in myself then.” That is fine. **The picture is not running away**.

Neither is wrong and neither is right. Calm, growth, care and envy all belong to you, and green can **carry everything**.

If very strong or painful feelings appear while you paint, **do not stay with them alone**. Talk about them with someone close or with an art therapist or therapist. This page does not replace professional care.

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Associations and stories

Our associations

Associations are the connections that form between us and a colour. We are not born with a ready-made list “green = this”, and yet some meanings repeat surprisingly often. They are usually made up of three layers, **the body**, **culture** and **what we have lived through ourselves**.

From the body

Green is the colour of **grass**, **leaves** and **the forest**. In daylight the human eye is also most sensitive to precisely the yellow-green part of the spectrum. No wonder the body easily links it with what is alive, with water and with shelter. Green says. **Life is possible here.**

Stephen and Rachel Kaplan described the theory that attention is restored in nature. Nothing forces us to concentrate, clouds, leaves and water occupy us gently and concentration rests. Studies show a small but repeatedly observed improvement of mood after time in nature. The evidence is not consistent, though, and it is not clear what role green itself plays, as opposed to quiet, fresh air or movement.

From culture

We give green when someone permits us something. It is the colour of ecology, hope and spring. In the Islamic tradition it is traditionally the colour of paradise. At the same time it is the colour of sickness and envy, “green with envy”, “green as bile”. The same colour can thus mean **hope** and nausea. **It depends on where we grew up.** In the section on cultures we will look at this in more detail.

From what you have lived

Grandmother's garden, the forest you went to as a child, a green school blackboard, a hospital corridor, a waiting room, a green jacket from holidays. These memories decide the most. **Two women can look at the same green** and one of them feels calm, the other tension because someone is about to call her to the board. The colour is the same. The story is not.

When you know where your associations come from, it is easier to tell what is “green” and what is your story about it.

A question for you

“What comes to mind first when I see a woman in a green dress or a man in a green shirt?”

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Stories

Why green means “go”

Today it is taken for granted, but it used to be different. On the railway white meant “clear”, green “caution” and red “stop”. White, however, was often confused with the moon or a lantern. And when a red glass broke, the signal showed white where it should have shown “stop”. That is why white was phased out from the end of the 19th century and green became the signal for “clear”. The first street traffic light with red, yellow and green was introduced in **1920** in Detroit by the policeman **William Potts**. Green thus did not get its permission from nature, but from a technical improvement.

Green with envy

In English they say “green-eyed monster”. It was made famous by **Shakespeare**. In The Merchant of Venice there is “green-eyed jealousy” and in Othello (around 1604) Iago warns of jealousy as a “green-eyed monster”. Perhaps it was helped by the fact that green is associated with illness and with unripe fruit that gives you stomach ache. In Czech it is “green with envy”. Envy is usually unpleasant, but it often shows what you long for.

The green that killed

In **1775** the Swedish chemist **Carl Wilhelm Scheele** produced a rich green pigment containing arsenic. In the 19th century it was put into wallpaper and dresses because it was cheap and beautifully fresh. Arsenic, however, is poisonous. It is said that arsenic from damp wallpaper may have contributed to the death of Napoleon on Saint Helena. That is not proven, it is disputed. All that is certain is that fashion sometimes hurts.

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Emotions and feelings

The same green can awaken **calm** in one of us and **envy** in another, sometimes even both in one day.

Green can awaken **a breath**, **the wish to begin again** and **tiredness from endless caring**. There is no **single fixed effect**. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that may appear before you are even aware of them.

Calm and relief

A feeling of **a breath**, of slowing down and "now I do not have to try". **The body lets go, the shoulders drop**.

And why?

Nature, quiet, a forest. **Green is a colour that wants nothing from us**. And the body recognises that. It has neither the sharpness of red nor the urgency of yellow, so it more easily invites us to slow down.

Ask yourself

"When did I last really take a breath?"

Hope and a new beginning

The wish to **begin again**. A cautious hope that things can change.

And why?

Spring after winter, the first leaves, giving the green light. A colour that says "you can go on". It is a shortcut from nature and from traffic, not a miraculous property of the colour.

A question for you

"What in me wants to start growing?"

Care and the heart

Caring, **love**, **compassion**. But also tiredness from always looking after others.

And why?

Green is linked with the heart (in the yogic tradition with the Anahata chakra, more about it in the chapter on the rainbow). It is the colour of **someone who nourishes and cares**.

If I asked you now

"Whom do I give the most to and what do I give myself?"

Balance, or boredom?

A feeling that everything is "**just right**". Sometimes also a feeling that nothing is happening.

And why?

Green lies in the middle of the rainbow and somehow **balances** everything. It is calm, but **calm can also be boredom**.

Try asking yourself

"Is my "just right" calm, or empty?"

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Envy and comparing

A sharp feeling that the other woman has more, and straight after it shame that I feel it.

And why?

"Green with envy." **Green-eyed jealousy** already in Shakespeare. Envy does not say you are bad. **It tells you what you long for.**

Ask yourself

"Whom have I envied lately and what exactly?"

Nausea and oversaturation

"**I have had it up to here**." My stomach turns at what I have to take in.

And why?

When we feel sick our face turns green. Hence "green as bile". **The body sometimes speaks in green first** and only afterwards in words.

A question for you

"What do I no longer want to take in?"

I do not wear green, but I feel good in the forest

That makes sense. Clothing is part of how you want to show yourself to the world, the forest is an environment in which you **spend time**. A green jumper does not carry **daylight, the movement of leaves**, distance, sounds or relief from duties.

And why?

With trees you perceive much more than one colour. So you do not have to start liking green things for time outdoors to do you good. At home a photograph of trees may be more pleasant than a green wall. **You can work with a colour indirectly too**.

If I asked you now

"What from the forest could I bring home?"

When green recharges and when it makes you sleepy

When you say "that green recharges me", you may be describing that **the wish to do something** is coming back, **tension eases** or you concentrate better. When it "makes you sleepy", it may be **a pleasant slowing down**, but also an environment that is too dark and monotonous for you.

And why?

Colours can change mood and level of arousal. In experiments green is sometimes less exciting than red, but brightness and saturation also play a big role. A bright green over the whole screen can feel much more urgent than a muted green picture. Research does not support one identical reaction of all people to every green.

Try asking yourself

"Is it the colour, or the surroundings around it?"

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My green is not the same as your green

A colour itself **does not experience anything**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), **the experience sticks to it. The colour then becomes a shortcut**. It is enough to catch sight of it and the body knows whether it can relax or should withdraw. That is why **your own reaction** matters most.

- **A green school blackboard**
  For one of us concentration and nice memories, for another stress from being called up.
- **Forest and garden**
  Shelter and safety, or darkness and fear of who is hiding there.
- **A withered flower on the windowsill**
  For one calm, for another guilt that she forgot to water it again.
- **A hospital corridor**
  Relief and care, or fear and waiting for news.
- **Green from home**
  A little garden or herbal tea from grandmother. A safety that comes to mind without our thinking about it.

Why does it attract me when I am not actually calm?

Perhaps it does not express how you feel. Perhaps you are drawn to what you are missing. **After a long period of rush and duties** green can recall **an ordinary breath**. **A bench, a tree, a walk with no destination**. Sometimes you are tired precisely because you have not had anywhere to lay your head for a long time. And suddenly the sight of leaves calms you simply because they are **soft, quiet and want nothing from you**.

Why does it seem unpleasant to me, on the contrary?

A vivid green is too sharp for you. It reminds you of a hospital corridor, a school blackboard or an environment where you did not feel well. **A dislike of green does not have to mean** that you reject nature or calm. Perhaps you are only rejecting **a particular memory**. Try to tell whether all greens bother you or only a certain kind. A mossy leaf can be beautiful even if you would not want a bright green wall even in a photograph.

Some colours we put aside. After a hard period we get rid of a dress or stop buying plants. **It is a way of protecting ourselves**. And when we are ready, **green often comes back by itself**, first as a small plant on the windowsill, then as a walk.

When to add it and when to take it away

Add it where it calms you and opens something pleasant. **Take it away when you catch yourself** looking away from it, everything feels too heavy or you finally want more light and spark. Notice the changes. Sage does me good, a bright green disturbs me. In winter it attracts me more than in hot summer. These are your concrete experiences. They do not have to fit into one answer “I like green”.

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If I asked you now

“Which sentence about green is loudest in me and whose is it actually?”

Green in cultures and traditions

In different cultures green has **surprisingly different meanings**. **Paradise, envy, luck, renewal and poison. None of these meanings excludes the others.** Let us look attentively and gently at a few places.

This chapter therefore shows **two levels**. First, how green is read in different **cultures**, and then how **traditional systems** look at it, using it as an image.

Green in different cultures

Islam

In Islam green is often seen as **the colour of paradise**. The Quran describes the inhabitants of paradise in green garments (for example Surah 18, verse 31, and Surah 76, verse 21).

Green refers to **greenery, water and life**, rare in the desert. Many Islamic countries have green in their flags.

A colour that is ordinary for us can be somewhere **a symbol of the highest blessing**.

Ireland

Ireland is nicknamed **the Emerald Isle** and the shamrock is its symbol. On **St Patrick's** Day people dress in green.

The nickname refers to a lush landscape fed by rain. **Green later became linked** with Irish nationalism too and is one of the stripes of the Irish tricolour.

The colour of the land and the colour of **identity** can merge.

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China

Green jade is valued in China as **a symbol of virtue and protection**. At the same time the idiom “to wear a green hat” means that a husband is being cheated on, and so a green hat should not be given as a gift.

Jade is linked with beauty and permanence. The idiom comes from folk speech.

The same colour can be a **treasure** in one object and an embarrassment in another.

The USA and money

The first American paper money of 1861 had a green back and people began to call it “**greenbacks**”. When smaller banknotes were introduced in 1929, green stayed, among other things because of the availability and durability of the pigment and its link with **trust in the state currency**.

The very original reason for choosing green is not certain. Different currencies use different colours.

Ask what money reminds you of. **The calm** of paid rent, **the freedom** to choose work, or pressure and worries? That too can show in how you perceive green.

Green in traditional systems

Every tradition looks at green **a little differently**, but all take it seriously. It is an old symbolic language and an inspiration, not a healing guide.

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Traditional Chinese medicine

In the Chinese tradition there are five elements. Wood, fire, earth, metal and water. **Green belongs to wood.** With wood are grouped spring, wind, the sour taste, anger and frustration as emotions, and the liver and gallbladder as organs. **Wood is the element of growth**. **Flexible, reaching upward**, that **bends and does not break**. The Chinese word qing (青) also covers green and blue together.

The liver here is not just an organ. The tradition ascribes to it keeping the flow of energy and emotions smooth. **When the flow stalls**, it describes irritability, tension and a feeling that it "is not going on". When wood grows freely, we are flexible and can plan and also change direction.

How it relates to the colour green. Green is the colour of wood, that is of growth and movement. And at the same time it is the supply for red. **Wood feeds fire.** Green is therefore not the opposite of red, it is its fuel. When you want more courage and energy, start with green. With rest, movement in nature, a change of routine.

What you can take from it. Ask yourself whether your wood is growing freely or is stuck. When it is stuck, it tends to be irritability and a feeling that you cannot go on. Movement, stretching, nature, a change of routine and saying aloud what is pressing all help. When there is too little of it, you lose direction and the wish to start anything. A small concrete plan, spring and the first shoots help. A herb in a pot is enough.

Ask yourself

"*What in my life is getting stuck and what would help me today **bend, and not break**?*"

Wood. Why precisely green, spring and a tree?

Imagine a tree in spring. New green leaves appear, branches lengthen and everything starts growing again. In the Chinese view wood represents precisely growth and flexibility. A branch is firm, but can also bend. When it is too stiff, it breaks more easily. Green can remind you of **a beginning** that does not have to be big or perfect.

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Growing is not enough. You also need to say what is pressing

For the third time you agree to something you do not want to do. Outwardly you say “sure”, inwardly irritation grows. Perhaps you need rest, help or to say that you will not take on another task. Anger has various causes and from being angry you cannot determine the state of the liver. It is more useful to catch what you are angry about and what you need to change. You can try saying a concrete need aloud: “I have no strength for that today” or “I need us to share this.”

Traditional Chinese medicine uses wood as an image. It is not a diagnosis and does not replace a doctor. From the assignment to the liver it does not follow that a green picture cleanses the liver.

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Ayurveda

Ayurveda is an old Indian teaching about health. In it a person is described by three types of "energy", the so-called doshas. Vata (air, restlessness), pitta (fire, intensity) and kapha (earth and water, heaviness). Colours are chosen to balance what there is too much of. Opposites are treated with opposites. **Green is cooling, calm and soothing**.

How it relates to the colour green. In contemporary Ayurvedic readings green and blue tones are often recommended for balancing pitta. **Sources on colours in Ayurveda differ in detail**, so take it as a general direction, not as a rule.

Pitta

This is how a woman is described who is purposeful, quick and thorough, and flares up easily. **Green cools and calms her.** The tradition advises cooling colours, such as green, blue or white.

- **Add green**
  ***Plants in the flat**, a sage or mint wall, green clothing.*
- **Add some cool**
  White and blue, water, a walk by a river or in a forest.

Vata

This is how a woman is described who is imaginative and quick, but restless, who is often cold and sleeps worse. Some sources recommend green, mainly in warmer shades. **It is best to notice how you really feel in green.**

- **Warmer shades**
  ***Olive and moss** for a blanket, a jumper or cushions. Calm without coldness.*
- **Evening and sleep**
  Soft, muted shades and warm light.

Kapha

This is how a woman is described who is calm, steady and patient, but who easily becomes heavy. Some sources do not recommend green for kapha, because it would calm her even more. **Lively colours** suit her.

- **Green in moderation**
  ***Lighter spring shades** (lime, apple), not a dark forest green.*
- **Add liveliness**
  Red, orange or yellow. A jumper, scarf, tablecloth.

An online test will not reliably determine your dosha. If you are more interested, consult a qualified Ayurvedic practitioner. It is not treatment.

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A Jungian view

Carl Gustav Jung, a Swiss psychiatrist, understood colours as symbols that have **two layers**. **A personal one** (what we have experienced with a colour) and one common to all people (images that repeat across eras and cultures).

In his lectures at the ETH in Zurich (1938 to 1939) he assigned green to **sensation**. He was interested in how we perceive the world through the body and senses. We see, hear, touch, **we are here and now**. Red for him belonged to feeling, green to the senses.

How it relates to the colour green. Green can remind you. **Come back to the body** and to what you are really perceiving right now. What do I see, hear, feel on my skin. Not what I think I should feel.

What you can take from it. When you are in your head, overloaded and constantly planning, green in the form of observation helps. Look out of the window at the greenery, touch a leaf, stroke moss. When, on the contrary, you live only in perceiving and do not want to change anything, red (feeling) or yellow (an idea) may do you good.

Jung did not want colours to be made into a dictionary. **The same green can be calm for one woman and boredom for another**. **We always ask what it means for you.** Jung's ideas about colours are a symbolic framework, not verified science.

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Feng shui

Feng shui is the Chinese art of arranging a space so that it is good to live in. In it green is the colour of **wood**, the element of growth, **vitality and new beginnings**. Wood belongs to spring and to the directions east and southeast. In the map of the house called the bagua, east is linked with family and health and southeast with growth and abundance. Green is therefore usually the colour of **health and family harmony**.

According to the tradition wood needs balance. Water feeds it, fire exhausts it and metal chops it. That is why heavy metal decorations are not recommended in the green part of the house in feng shui.

Simple tips

- **Do you want more growth?**
  Start with one healthy plant in a place where you will see it every day.
- **Want more calm?**
  Choose sage, moss or olive. Leave rich green for small accents.
- **Is it already too much?**
  Add wood, linen, cream or more free space.
- **Green does not suit you?**
  Swap it for another colour. Your feeling is more important than the rules.

What people say and what holds true

MYTH The more plants, the more luck.

TRUTH According to the tradition a healthy and tended plant counts. Neglected and withered plants, on the contrary, drain energy. Fewer, but healthy ones are better.

MYTH Green brings money.

TRUTH The southeast is the zone of growth and abundance, but green alone ensures nothing. The whole matters.

MYTH Green is always calm.

TRUTH Rich, sour shades can also exhaust. **Calm** comes rather from soft, natural tones.

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Clothing

Green in clothing behaves similarly to green in a flat. Best as a colour that **calms** you and keeps you grounded. According to traditional advisers your personal element matters too. Wood helps one person, green does not suit another. In practice. Let your body and the mirror advise you.

What green works well with

- **Wood and linen**
  A natural, lived-in impression. Green does not have to shout in them.
- **Cream and white**
  A lighter and airier whole in which green breathes.
- **Brown and earth**
  More earthy and grounding. Green grows, brown holds.
- **Red**
  A strong counterpart. Watch the size of the areas so that it does not look Christmassy.
- **Blue**
  A cooler and calmer impression. Try which one will be the main one.
- **Grey and black**
  An elegant and deep impression. Use only a little black.

Before you repaint a whole room, try **a throw**, **a fabric** or a larger colour **sample**. Hold a large sample to the wall and look at it in the morning and in the evening in your own lighting. **A screen does not replace the shade**.

Feng shui has several schools and the recommendations differ. **Take them as inspiration** for how it feels to live in a space.

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Feng shui room by room

What works, what to watch for and a simple tip.

Living room

What works. Plants, green cushions or a curtain. They suit mainly the east and southeast part of a room. **Sage** and a muted olive may suit one wall or a larger textile, they are less conspicuous than bright greens and let the people and things around stand out.

What to watch for. In a dark room a lot of grey-green can feel dull. Forest green creates a cosy corner, but takes away a feeling of lightness. If the room is heavy and shaded, start with an armchair, a picture or a smaller area.

A simple tip. Linen, wool and wood make sage and olive **softer and more natural**. A glossy rich green gives a more artificial impression than a matt one.

Kitchen and dining room

What works. Herbs on the windowsill and green in textiles. Water is already there, so wood has something to drink. Olive with wood can feel earthy and cosy.

What to watch for. In a small north-facing room first compare a sample with a lighter variant. A cold green can emphasise a feeling of chill. On the worktop you need light in which you can tell food apart well, not a green tint.

A simple tip. Wood, ceramics and linen warm olive and sage. A cold green next to glossy metal adds chill.

Bedroom

What works. Soft and muted shades (sage, moss). Plants yes, but healthy and tended. **A muted green** behind the bed or in the bed linen, if it is pleasant for you.

What to watch for. A garish lime on a large area is too striking for evening rest. Green coloured lighting is not automatically suitable for sleeping. In the evening brightness and the time of lighting matter too.

A simple tip. Cotton and linen in a muted green are pleasant to look at and to touch. A cold gloss suits falling asleep less well. What do you see just before you fall asleep and how does it feel to look at it?

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Children's room

What works. Calmer green shades help to slow down, especially in connection with wood and plants. A green rug, cushion or storage box is soft and movable.

What to watch for. In a child's room the child's taste also decides. A muted background and a few livelier details are easier to change than a whole bright room.

Study

What works. A soft sage or a green picture give the eyes **a calmer background** between tasks. Green alone does not raise performance, but combined with natural materials it helps calm.

What to watch for. If you edit photographs, judge shades or do make-up, large rich green areas and green light can distort the perception of other colours.

A simple tip. Matt wood or paper leave green in the background. A glossy green surface in the main view can reflect into the eyes.

Bathroom and hall

What works. In a bathroom a blue-green can be pleasant on tiles. In a hall a smaller picture or a plant in a lighter spot.

What to watch for. A green bulb by the mirror distorts the skin, so keep neutral light by the mirror. In a narrow dark hall a large forest-coloured area can visually close the space.

A simple tip. Does the entrance welcome you, or does the first look shout at you? And how does it feel to look at yourself in the mirror?

Where to put a plant or a green picture

You can use **a potted houseplant**, a picture of a forest or your own green painting. In feng shui they are meant to recall growth and renewal. In an ordinary flat look for a place where you will gladly see them and where they will make sense to you. Place a living plant according to how much light it needs. If the conditions for it are not there, choose a picture.

If I asked you now

"*Why do I want green at home?* ***What is it meant to bring me, calm, growth or freshness?***"

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Colour frequency and phototherapy

Green light can recall **a forest**, **leaves** or a lamp on a writing desk. Let us say which of that is **atmosphere** and which is already **treatment**.

And it is exactly here that it is good to put **miraculous promises** aside. A green lamp is not a magic device for mood, concentration or chakras.

How it can work when it is “just light”

Light passes energy to substances that can absorb it. In the eye it triggers signals to the brain. In the skin it can trigger other biological processes. A photon is one small packet of this energy. **The colour does not say everything.** A weak green indicator light and a therapeutic device have very different parameters, that is spectrum, intensity and duration of exposure.

Where light is really studied

Winter depression

If your mood repeatedly worsens markedly in the dark months, you sleep a lot and ordinary things stop pleasing you, talk it over with a doctor or psychiatrist. For seasonal winter depression **strong white light** with UV filtered out is used, often in the morning. It helps influence the daily rhythm and in some people eases depressive symptoms. Distance and time are part of the treatment procedure, not instructions for using any lamp.

Skin

A dermatologist may recommend narrow-band UVB for psoriasis and some eczemas. That is invisible ultraviolet radiation that dampens the excessive activity of some immune cells in the skin. A green bulb does not replace this procedure.

Newborn jaundice

Special blue to blue-green light changes bilirubin in the skin into forms that the body can excrete more easily. A paediatrician decides on the need for treatment according to measurements and the child's condition. It is a concrete chemical effect of light, not the effect of a colour's mood.

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Migraine

In a migraine ordinary light can be unpleasant to painful. In experiments certain narrow-band green light worsened pain less than several other tested colours and in some people weak green light brought relief. A smaller preliminary study with green LEDs also recorded fewer days with headache, but it had limitations and is not enough on its own for a firm conclusion about treatment. **That does not mean green automatically calms everyone.**

When to ask about green light

If you have a diagnosed migraine and light makes your symptoms markedly worse, you can ask a neurologist about options for dealing with light sensitivity and whether it makes sense to try green light as a supplement to care. Keep a record of days with pain, intensity and conditions, otherwise it is hard to tell a real change.

Before buying, ask for the spectrum, intensity and clinical evidence of the particular device. A green screen or a decorative LED strip may not match the light that was studied. Do not stare at the source and do not carry on through pain or worsening vision.

A green picture and a green lamp

In painting you work with the experience and meaning of a colour. In phototherapy the bodily response to precisely described light is observed. Both experiences can have their place. Choose a treatment according to the difficulties you want to address.

A question for you

"In what light is it easy for me to slow down?"

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Astrotype and colours

Are you Pisces, Libra, Sagittarius, or another sign? Astrological type is a much broader topic than just the sun sign. If you want to go really into **depth**, knowing only the date of birth is not enough. The exact place and time of birth matter too, because only from them are the ascendant, the position of the Moon, the planets and other parts of the horoscope calculated. Here, though, we really keep only to the edge of what relates to colours.

The ascendant is the sign that was rising on the eastern horizon at the moment of your birth. According to astrological tradition it shows how you come across outwardly and how you enter the world, while the Sun sign describes more who you are inside. For each sign you will therefore find not only its character but also a short note on how the colour fits when it is your ascendant.

Aries (21 March – 19 April)

Your green

spring yellow-green · lime · grass green

A green that **calms you** without slowing you down.

Aries is linked in astrology with Mars, fire and the start of spring. Green is for it a colour that grows. It gives you **a breath** and perspective and does not take away the wish to start.

What Aries is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality cardinal · ruler Mars

Aries opens the zodiac and you can tell that it is first. It is a **pioneer** who gets into things before thinking them through perfectly. It is direct, impatient and likes to compete. It gets angry quickly but forgives quickly too.

Its strength is the **courage** to begin. Weaker is perseverance in long, slow matters. It does best where something is happening and where it can act at once.

What it can support in you

Green can support moments when you want to catch your breath before setting off. It suits places where your energy is quicker than your patience.

With Aries, strength is in the courage to begin. Green adds a feeling that things can grow even without pressure.

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Shadow impatience with things that need time

In the shadow Aries plants and immediately pulls it up to find out whether anything is growing yet. Impatience meets everything that wants time, that is relationships, learning and healing.

Aries does not like delays. A very calm green may seem too little passionate and slow to you.

A rich lime on a large area, on the other hand, can add the restlessness you wanted to be rid of.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you slow down and **patiently** watch what is growing.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mars red as an accent.

red · orange · sun yellow

They add a spark so that green is not only calm.

Aries as ascendant

When Aries is your ascendant, you come across as direct, lively and decisive. People may see you as someone who gets straight to the point, and the first impression tends to be brisk.

Green gives your drive calm. Fresh spring shades suit you more than a dark forest green.

In everyday life

*Keep green for moments when you want **a breath** without delay. A mug, a plant on the desk, a walk.*

When you are too quick again, try one slow green detail and watch what happens in it.

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Taurus (20 April – 20 May)

Your green

grass green · olive · bottle green

A green you can **feel with your hands. A garden, bark, leaves.**

Taurus is an earth sign linked with Venus, the senses and stability. According to the tradition green belongs to Venus and suits Taurus as the colour of the garden, food and security.

What Taurus is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality fixed · ruler Venus

Taurus is an earthy, **patient** and sensual sign. It likes good food, pleasant materials, nature and security. It gets going slowly, but once it decides on something, it persists.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to enjoy the present moment. The weaker side tends to be stubbornness and finding it hard to let go of what is familiar.

What it can support in you

Green can support sensuality, the wish to enjoy a moment and contact with the body. A garden, herbs, wood and freshly picked fruit are its language.

With Taurus it is often not only about the colour but about the material. **Moss, linen or matt ceramics** feel different from glossy green plastic.

Shadow rooted in a routine from which nothing grows

In the shadow Taurus settles so deeply that it stops growing. Comfort is pleasant, but a tree you never replant eventually stops bearing fruit.

Taurus needs tangibility. A green that is too dark and dense can add to a feeling of stagnation.

And once you are used to it, you do not want to let go of anything you know. Then green looks like decoration for a calm that is already more of a standstill.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you see **what is already slowly growing** and give it light.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Venus pink and something light.

pink · cream · light wood

They add lightness so that green is not only heavy.

Taurus as ascendant

When Taurus is your ascendant, you come across as calm, stable and pleasant. You build trust slowly and people often feel firm ground in you.

Taurus gives a calm, firm impression. Moss and olive add naturalness, a fresh green lightens it.

In everyday life

Green can remind you that pleasure is not a reward for performance. ***Enjoy*** *a moment even without having earned it.*

Plant one plant and watch it grow. Without hurry, that is your pace.

Gemini (21 May – 20 June)

Your green

spring yellow-green · mint · turquoise green

A playful green that **balances** a chaos of ideas.

Gemini is linked with Mercury, movement and curiosity. Green gives them support in the middle of their thoughts and reminds them that even ideas need time before they grow.

What Gemini is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Gemini is **curious**, talkative and adaptable. It learns quickly, likes to tell stories and enjoys it when a lot is going on around it. It can see several sides of one thing.

Its strength is **lightness** and wit. The weaker side tends to be scatteredness and a tendency to start more things than can be finished.

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What it can support in you

Green can give a quick head a moment of calm. It suits places where your thoughts jump around and you want to stop for a while.

Gemini often enjoys fresh and light shades. Mint or spring green are playful but do not tire.

Shadow oversaturation with information and nausea from stimuli

In the shadow Gemini reads, listens and shares so much that its stomach turns. **Green in the face** as a signal "I have had it up to here" says it can take in nothing more.

Gemini gets bored quickly. Green alone may seem not playful and not interesting enough to you.

And once your head is full, another striking green on a screen or a wall only adds a stimulus.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **slow down** and pick just one thing to contemplate.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Mercury blue or orange.

light blue · orange · white

They add playfulness and air so that green is not only calm.

Gemini as ascendant

When Gemini is your ascendant, you come across as lively, friendly and chatty. People may see you as curious and youthful, even if inside you are perhaps calmer.

Mint or spring green catch their lightness, a dark green would weigh it down.

In everyday life

With Gemini green can happily keep changing. One time a scarf, another a mug, another just a leaf on the desk.

*You do not have to have one "own green" for ever. Try what **amuses** you today.*

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Cancer (21 June – 22 July)

Your green

sage · mint · soft moss

Green as **a garden** you can hide in.

Cancer is linked with the Moon, water and the start of summer. It is caring and sensitive. Green is for it **a garden** where it can take a breath.

What Cancer is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality cardinal · ruler Moon

Cancer is **caring**, sensitive and strongly connected to home and family. It has a good memory for feelings and relationships. It enters the world cautiously, much like a crab with its shell.

Its strength is **empathy** and the ability to create safety. The weaker side tends to be changeable moods and a tendency to withdraw when it feels hurt.

What it can support in you

Green can support a feeling of home and the wish to care. Herbs on the windowsill, flowers or tea from your own leaves have a special charm for Cancer.

With Cancer it is important that the colour is soft and natural. Green suits it in a blanket, a cushion and in evening light.

Shadow clinging and anxious protection of loved ones

In the shadow Cancer keeps everything and everyone close so that nothing happens to them. Care turns into control and the garden into a fence.

Cancer is vulnerable. A green that is too cold can strengthen sadness even more.

And when you already look after everyone, another green that wants to “grow” can remind you that you yourself are left without watering.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you return **care to yourself too**, for example with a plant you look after only for pleasure.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Moon white and silver bring back the light.

Moon white · silver · apricot

They add dawn so that the garden is not only shady.

Cancer as ascendant

When Cancer is your ascendant, you come across as gentle and careful. At first you keep your distance, but then warmth unfolds and people see in you someone who will look after them.

Sage and moss add calm, a very rich one would act like a curtain.

In everyday life

Green in a soft fabric and in evening light is safest for you.

Give yourself something warming for yourself, not just for others. ***Water yourself too.***

Leo (23 July – 22 August)

Your green

emerald · royal green · green with gold

A green that gives your radiance **dignity**.

Leo is linked with the Sun, creativity and joy. Emerald green gives its radiance depth, because the sun leans precisely on greenery to rest on what is alive.

What Leo is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality fixed · ruler Sun

Leo is **generous**, proud and creative. It likes to give, likes to rejoice and needs others to see and appreciate it. It is loyal and has a big heart.

Its strength is **warmth** and the ability to inspire others. The weaker side tends to be sensitivity to criticism and a tendency to want to be the centre of attention.

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What it can support in you

Green can support self-expression in a calm form. Emerald and bottle green carry prestige without shouting.

Leo often does not need permission to be seen. Green reminds it that strength can also be **quiet and steady**.

Shadow envy of other people's successes

In the shadow Leo watches who shines more. The golden heart turns into green-eyedness that measures how much applause others got.

Leo does not want to go unnoticed. A muted green may seem unobtrusive to you.

And when you already envy, green summons self-comparison even more.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you see **what is truly yours** and not envy.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Sun gold and yellow.

gold · sun yellow · cream

They add light so that green does not stay only in shadow.

Leo as ascendant

When Leo is your ascendant, you come across as self-assured, warm and striking. You enter a room in a way that people notice you even when you do not want them to.

Emerald and royal green add dignity.

In everyday life

Green can remind Leo that being seen is not the same as proving your worth.

*Sometimes the **calm** of the green crown of a tree is enough. A tree does not need applause.*

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Virgo (23 August – 22 September)

Your green

sage · olive · khaki

A green that gives order **freshness**.

Virgo is an earth sign linked with Mercury, detail and practicality. Green suits it as the colour of the garden, herbs and health.

What Virgo is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Virgo is **meticulous**, attentive and practical. It notices details that others overlook and likes to be useful. It tends to be modest and judges itself more strictly than others.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to improve things. The weaker side tends to be perfectionism, worries and a tendency to criticise itself.

What it can support in you

Green can support the wish to care for the body, the home and small things. Herbs, tea and fresh vegetables are its natural companions.

With Virgo green works in muted, natural shades. It gives order **freshness** and health.

Shadow oversaturation and exhaustion from constant improving

In the shadow Virgo improves and corrects and never has enough. Like a garden that is always being weeded and has no time to grow.

Virgo is critical, above all of itself. A pale green can strengthen self-criticism even more.

And a green linked with health can add pressure to “live correctly”.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **allow yourself the ordinary**, for example a houseplant that does not have to be perfect.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Mercury blue or white.

light blue · white · sand

They add purity and air so that green is not only practical.

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Virgo as ascendant

When Virgo is your ascendant, you come across as neat, restrained and reliable. People see you as observant and sensible, sometimes even overly reserved.

A muted sage and olive suit it more than a garish green.

In everyday life

Green can remind you that something can be good enough even without a final correction.

No leaf is perfectly symmetrical. ***That very imperfection is alive.***

Libra (23 September – 22 October)

Your green

mint · sage · pink-green

A green that brings **balance** and beauty.

Libra is linked with Venus, beauty and balance. According to the tradition green belongs to Venus and suits Libra as the colour of harmony.

What Libra is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality cardinal · ruler Venus

Libra longs for **harmony**, beauty and justice. It is diplomatic, sociable and has a feel for aesthetics. It lives best in relationships in which it does not feel alone.

Its strength is **tact** and the ability to see both sides. The weaker side tends to be hesitation and a tendency to avoid conflict even when it would help.

What it can support in you

Green can support **balance** between what you give and what you receive. It suits places where you look for calm between two sides.

Libra has a feeling for aesthetics. Green in a delicate and refined form adds balance and elegance.

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Shadow endless balancing that leads nowhere

In the shadow Libra weighs up until nothing changes. Balance turns into immobility and calm into a feeling that nothing is happening.

Libra finds it hard to decide. A green without a companion may seem austere and too balanced to you.

And when you hesitate, a green that everyone praises can strengthen the feeling that you must always be in balance.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **decide** and let one side outweigh.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Venus pink or white.

pink · white · cream

They add tenderness and delicacy so that green is not only balanced.

Libra as ascendant

When Libra is your ascendant, you come across as elegant, pleasant and balanced. People like you for your tact, even if inside you take a long time to decide.

Mint and sage are their colours of harmony.

In everyday life

Green can remind Libra that even one side can be beautiful when it is chosen.

It does not have to be put to a vote. ***Choose one today.***

Scorpio (23 October – 21 November)

Your green

dark forest · bottle green · fir

A green with **depth** and mystery.

Scorpio is a water sign and in traditional astrology is also linked with Mars, intensity and inner strength. A dark forest green has a depth that suits it.

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What Scorpio is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality fixed · ruler Mars, in the newer view also Pluto

Scorpio is **intense**, deep and loyal. It feels strongly, but does not always show it. It dislikes superficiality and likes to get to what is hidden.

Its strength is **determination** and the ability to transform. The weaker side tends to be distrust, jealousy and a need to keep things under control.

What it can support in you

Green can support the ability to transform, calm and deep rest. A forest at dusk is Scorpio's green.

Scorpio cannot bear superficiality. Green in a dark, natural shade carries dignity and depth.

Shadow bitterness and grudges held

In the shadow Scorpio holds on to what someone once did to it. Bile settles and green takes on a tint of bitterness.

Scorpio cannot bear superficiality. A fresh light green may seem shallow to you.

And when you are holding an old **grievance**, a dark green can deepen it even more.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **forgive yourself and others** and let the poisonous grievance drain away.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Mars dark red.

wine · grey · beige

They add warmth so that depth is not only cold.

Scorpio as ascendant

When Scorpio is your ascendant, you come across as focused, mysterious and strong. People sense the intensity of your gaze and often feel that you know more than you say.

Dark forest and bottle green underline its depth.

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In everyday life

Green can remind Scorpio that a forest is deep, but also alive.

Letting go of a grievance does not mean forgetting. ***It means ceasing to feed it.***

Sagittarius (22 November – 21 December)

Your green

green meadow · forest lake · olive

The green of roads, forests and **freedom**.

Sagittarius belongs to Jupiter, fire and movement. According to the tradition green is the colour of Jupiter and the colour of roads, forests and **freedom**.

What Sagittarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter

Sagittarius is **optimistic**, open and free-spirited. It loves travel, new experiences and the search for meaning. It speaks honestly, sometimes a little too directly.

Its strength is **enthusiasm** and faith in a good outcome. The weaker side tends to be impatience with detail and a tendency to promise more than can be managed.

What it can support in you

Green can support the wish to go out, into nature and on journeys. A forest, a meadow and a look into the distance are its language.

Sagittarius loves freedom. Green gives it a space in which it can breathe and search.

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Shadow always searching for a better place further on

In the shadow Sagittarius believes that the grass is always greener over the next hill. It never stays anywhere long enough to take root.

Sagittarius cannot bear restriction. A very muted green may seem restrictive to you.

And when you are dissatisfied with what you have around you, another green landscape on a screen adds longing to be elsewhere.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you see **what is already growing underfoot** and welcome the present place.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Jupiter blue and soft shades of water.

sky blue · aquamarine · cream

They add perspective so that green is not only a boundary.

Sagittarius as ascendant

When Sagittarius is your ascendant, you come across as open, jovial and adventurous. People see you as someone with a wide outlook and an appetite for discovery.

A fresh green and olive match its wish to set off.

In everyday life

Green can remind Sagittarius that a journey can also lead into your own backyard.

You do not have to manage three continents today. ***One tree is enough.***

Capricorn (22 December – 19 January)

Your green

bottle green · moss · khaki

A green that gives **growth without haste**.

Capricorn is an earth sign linked with Saturn, structure and perseverance. Green gives it support in nature and reminds it that everything grows at its own pace.

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What Capricorn is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality cardinal · ruler Saturn

Capricorn is **responsible**, goal-oriented and disciplined. It likes to build and is not afraid of a long road. It has a dry sense of humour and shows it only to those it trusts.

Its strength is **perseverance** and the ability to see things through. The weaker side tends to be strictness with itself, reserve and a tendency to put joy off until later.

What it can support in you

Green can support calm and a feeling that things have their time. Bottle green and moss carry a dignity that suits Capricorn.

With Capricorn green can remind that rest is not laziness. Even a forest pauses in winter.

Shadow tiredness from eternal responsibility

In the shadow Capricorn carries everything alone and never asks for help. A tree without winter rest eventually sheds its leaves too early.

Capricorn is strict with itself. A cheerful green may seem out of place to you.

And when you are tired, a dark and heavy green deepens the seriousness even more.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you admit that **even a forest rests**, and allow yourself **a winter pause**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Something just for pleasure.

warm white · apricot · soft natural materials

They add softness so that green is not only duty.

Capricorn as ascendant

When Capricorn is your ascendant, you come across as serious, mature and reserved. People may see you as older than you are, and only later discover how funny you are.

Moss and bottle green suit it and add calm.

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In everyday life

Green can remind you that you do not have to work for joy first.

Not even a new plant needs a five-year plan. ***Treat yourself to one.***

Aquarius (20 January – 18 February)

Your green

turquoise green · aquamarine · pure green

The green of clean air and **independence**.

Aquarius is linked with independence, originality and the need to go its own way. Green suits it as the colour of clean air and of a space where you can breathe.

What Aquarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality fixed · ruler Saturn, in the newer view also Uranus

Aquarius is **independent**, original and idealistic. It is interested in ideas, humanity and the future. It wants to go its own way and does not like adapting to expectations.

Its strength is **perspective** and the ability to come up with new things. The weaker side tends to be distance from feelings and a tendency to withdraw when there is too much closeness.

What it can support in you

Green can support the courage to be different and stay calm inside. Turquoise green and aquamarine feel modern and fresh.

Aquarius often does not need a “right” green. It needs a green nobody expected yet.

Shadow escaping into solitude

In the shadow Aquarius hides in nature from people. Solitude helps, but it can turn into an escape from closeness.

A classic green may seem too predictable.

And sometimes the wish to be different can be so strong that originality turns into just another rule.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **stay yourself** and still let someone closer.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

One unexpected colour accent.

scarlet · purple · grey

They add surprise so that green is not only expected.

Aquarius as ascendant

When Aquarius is your ascendant, you come across as independent, a little unusual and friendly. People see you as an original personality who keeps their own space.

Green in an unexpected combination, for example with purple, underlines originality.

In everyday life

Green can remind Aquarius that originality does not have to mean doing everything the opposite way.

Sometimes green is simply pretty. ***And that is enough too.***

Pisces (19 February – 20 March)

Your green

light sea green · mint · seaweed

Green as **water**, soft algae and dreams.

Pisces is a water sign linked with imagination, sensitivity and the inner world. According to the tradition green is the colour of Jupiter, water and dreaming. A soft green like algae suits it.

What Pisces is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter, in the newer view also Neptune

Pisces is **empathic**, intuitive and dreamy. It picks up the moods around it and often has a rich imagination. It frequently has a bond with art, music and spirituality.

Its strength is **compassion** and creative fantasy. The weaker side tends to be merging with other people's feelings, escaping into dreams and difficulty setting boundaries.

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What it can support in you

Green can support calm, grounding and a feeling that you can let yourself be carried. Soft water shades are your language.

With Pisces it is important that the green is not sharp. Sage, mint and seaweed carry softness.

Shadow exhaustion from empathy

In the shadow Pisces feels other people's pain as its own. Green as compassion turns into overload and a loss of boundaries.

Pisces easily dissolves. A green that is too sharp can pull you out of calm.

And when you are full of impressions, another green landscape with people and stories adds more feelings.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **set boundaries** and let other people's pain flow on.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Jupiter blue and soft shades of water.

sky blue · icy · cream

They add depth so that green is not only soft.

Pisces as ascendant

When Pisces is your ascendant, you come across as gentle, dreamy and adaptable. People like to project their wishes onto you and tend to be kind to you.

Light sea green and seaweed suit them, a sharp green would overpower the softness.

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In everyday life

Green can remind you that a dream takes shape only when you do something.

You do not have to change your whole life at once. ***Plant one small plant.***

FOR A DEEPER LOOK

- **Seasons**

Green is the colour of spring and summer, when everything sprouts and bears. But a dark forest in winter is green too. Aries and Taurus belong to spring, Cancer and Leo to summer. Ask yourself when you reach for green.

- **Time of day**

Green is the colour of morning and afternoon, when there is the most light outside. In the morning it refreshes, in the evening it calms and late at night it can seem unusual, even cold.

- **Years of life**

Jupiter, the planet that according to the tradition relates to green most, goes around the zodiac in roughly twelve years. Astrology reads cycles of growth and expansion in this. Green may feel close to you in years when something new is being founded, and less so when you just need to hold on. Both are natural.

A question for you

“Where in your life is something turning green and growing right now?”

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Colour for your website and business

Yes, mainly where you promise care, nature or stability. But green is not a promise for free.

In business green is a peculiar combination. With one hand it holds **health and nature**, with the other **money**. People trust it and watch it at the same time. It promises calm, care and growth, and that is why it is good to know what you promise by it before you let it into a logo, a website or an advertisement.

By itself, though, it does not attract customers like a magnet. It can help create **a trustworthy impression**, but what mainly decides is still what you sell, to whom and how well it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Green can say, for example

"You can take a breath." "It is natural." "You can carry on." "It is all right."

- **Health and nature.** Greenery is linked with what is alive. It suits anywhere you promise freshness, naturalness or health.
- **Calm and care.** It is one of the calmest colours. It speaks of regeneration, a breath and a slower pace.
- **Permission and safety.** "Giving the green light" means permitting. Green in an interface often means "continue" or "it is all right".
- **Money and stability.** Dark green shades feel dignified and stable. Green is linked with money historically too.
- **Sustainability.** Today green is the colour of ecology. A customer expects real actions to stand behind it.

Depending on the shade, though, it can also act differently. A dark forest green is **stable and premium**, sage and mint **gentle and caring**, olive **earthy and crafted**, lime **fresh and bold**.

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Simple tips

- **Shade by role**
  Dark (forest, emerald) for stability and premium feel, fresh spring for health and a new beginning, sage and mint for gentle care and wellness, olive for earthiness and craft.
- **Combinations**
  Cream, white and brown for a natural impression, gold for prestige, powder pink for tenderness.
- **Proof**
  Use the words “bio”, “eco” and “natural” only when you can back them up.
- **Not just for a trend**
  Green “because it is fashionable” gives itself away quickly.
- **Legibility**
  For ordinary text a contrast of at least 4.5 to 1 is recommended (the WCAG accessibility rule). Light green text on a white background is often hard to read.
- **Colour blindness**
  About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Do not use these two colours as the only difference between two things.

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Professions where it is a Yes

Care, healthcare and pharmacies

We link greenery with forest, meadow and rest. A woman in care needs to feel she can take a breath. Green alarms nobody, does not shout and does not press. It speaks quietly, and that is why it suits care. In France a pharmacy has a green cross. Pharmacies used to use a red cross and people confused them with the Red Cross, so a law of 1913 introduced green. Why exactly green is not known precisely.

Healthy food, bio and gardening

Bio, gardening and healthy food can explain their focus quickly thanks to green. Freshness and naturalness is a promise that the customer expects you to keep. Let mainly the products, photographs and materials speak. Green is just their quiet companion.

Coaching, therapy and wellness

A muted green, for example sage or mint, can accompany services focused on balance and regeneration. Try it next to real photographs and natural materials and see whether the result captures your work.

Finance and consulting

A darker green also suits finance and consulting, where you want to seem **stable** and trustworthy. Add cream or gold so that it does not seem too stern.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Dramatic and loud brands.** Nightlife, adrenaline, quick sales (“buy now”). Green here seems too quiet.
- **Luxury in black and gold.** Green gets lost in such a combination. Consider a dark emerald rather as an accessory.
- **Companies that promise naturalness but have nothing to prove it.** Green is a promise. If you do not keep it, the customer notices faster than with another colour.
- **Brands that want to stand out among other greens.** When everyone around uses the same green and you need to be recognisable, look for another shade or another main motif.

Put important information on green areas with well readable contrast. Do not mark success or error by colour alone. Add a word or symbol.

Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the green?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that green means nature and care.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

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Examples from the market

You know green from cafés, petrol stations and shops. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Starbucks (cafés)**
  The original logo of 1971 was brown. After Il Giornale bought Starbucks in 1987, a new logo arose with green and a modified siren. Aha. A change of colour can change how we perceive a brand even when the product stays the same.

- **BP (energy)**
  In 2000 BP introduced the new Helios logo, a sun symbol in green and yellow, and the slogan “beyond petroleum”. Critics later accused it of greenwashing, a green image without matching actions. Aha. Green raises expectations. When actions do not match, disillusionment arises.

- **Heineken (brewery)**
  The beer is typically sold in a green bottle with a red star. In February 2013 Heineken stopped producing brown bottles for the Dutch market and switched to green ones, which it already used for export. Aha. The colour of packaging can become such a strong sign that you recognise it at first sight.

- **John Deere (farm machinery)**
  The first Deere machines got a green frame and yellow wheels sometime between 1870 and 1880 and in 1910 the company decided that all its machines would be marked this way. In 2017 a court confirmed that the combination is a famous trademark. Aha. Green with yellow became a mark of recognition for the company.

What they share is that green carries a simple message. **Nature, care, permission**. And the more it promises, the more has to stand behind it.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, customers and how consistent a brand is. Take it as an idea you will check, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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Different colour combinations

Green + red

How it feels

Spark and calm at once. Red is the opposite of green on the colour wheel. Side by side they bring each other out and a strong contrast arises.

When it suits

When you want **energy** and at the same time do not want to overdo it.

Specific shades



green + red
vividly



bottle green + wine
deeply



sage + terracotta red
gently



grass green + scarlet
loudly



olive + brick
earthily

In practice

Red flowers among leaves. A green jumper and red lipstick. A red cushion on a green sofa.

Watch out

Large areas of both can feel **Christmassy** and tire the eyes.

Green + orange

How it feels

Joy in calm. Green and orange are a warm and cool pair. Orange warms green, green calms orange. Like autumn leaves.

When it suits

When you want **natural optimism** without pressure to perform.

Specific shades



green + orange
vividly



olive + terracotta
autumnally



sage + apricot
softly



bottle green + pumpkin
richly



mint + peach
freshly

In practice

An orange accessory with green clothing. A pumpkin in the garden. An orange candle among plants.

Watch out

A rich orange and a rich green side by side can feel **loud**.

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Green + yellow

How it feels

Lightness and cheerfulness. Yellow is a neighbour of green on the colour wheel. It brightens greenery and a spring yellow-green arises.

When it suits

When you want **a spring mood** even though it is November.

Specific shades



green + lemon
freshly



grass green + buttery
springlike



olive + mustard
earthily



mint + vanilla
gently



bottle green + golden
festively

In practice

A yellow accessory in a green room. Mint and yellow in the kitchen.

Watch out

A rich yellow-green alone can recall **warning graphics**.

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Green + blue

How it feels

Deep calm and perspective. Blue is the other neighbour of green. Mixed together they give blue-green, turquoise and sea tones. Both are cool and calm.

When it suits

When you want **calm** and water around you.

Specific shades



green + blue
calmly



blue-green + light blue
like the sea



sage + sky blue
airily



bottle green + navy
deeply



mint + icy
freshly

In practice

Turquoise in a bathroom. A blue scarf and a green dress. Sea shades in a bedroom.

Watch out

When there is too much of both, it can be **cold** and the mood quiet and sad.

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Green + indigo

How it feels

Depth and silence. Green next to a deep blue-violet gains depth, like a forest at dusk.

When it suits

When you want to **go more inward**, to your own intuition.

Specific shades



green + indigo
quietly



bottle green + ink
deeply



olive + dark purple
earthily



sage + lavender
gently



blue-green + indigo
like the sea

In practice

A dark green wall and indigo textiles. Evening lighting.

Watch out

When there is too much indigo, the mood tends to be **heavy** and pensive.

Green + violet

How it feels

Something magical and playful. Purple is on the wheel almost the opposite of yellow and with green it makes a pretty contrast. Together they recall woodland flowers, lavender and violets.

When it suits

When you want **mystery** in a calm setting.

Specific shades



green + purple
magically



sage + lavender
gently



grass green + orchid
playfully



bottle green + plum
deeply



mint + lilac
airily

In practice

Lavender in a green garden. A purple shawl with a green coat.

Watch out

Too much purple can feel **dramatic**.

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Green + pink

How it feels

Tenderness and self-care. Pink is red diluted with white. Green makes it even softer and gentler, like peonies and petals.

When it suits

When you want **kindness** to yourself and to others.

Specific shades



green + pink
tenderly



sage + powder
gently



bottle green + raspberry
deeply



mint + pastel pink
airily



olive + old rose
earthily

In practice

Powder pink and sage in a bedroom. A pink blanket on a green sofa.

Watch out

Sweet pastel combinations can feel **childish** if you do not add something earthy.

Green + grey

How it feels

Grey mutes green and green enlivens grey. A **grey-green** arises, elegant and calm.

When it suits

When there is too much of everything and you want **distance and calm**.

Specific shades



green + grey
calmly



sage + silver
airily



bottle green + slate
deeply



mint + light grey
freshly



olive + stone
earthily

In practice

A grey-green wall. A grey dress and a green scarf.

Watch out

Too much grey-green can feel **dull**.

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Green + brown

How it feels

Support and naturalness. Brown and green are a natural pair. Trunk and leaves, soil and grass. Green grows, brown holds.

When it suits

When you want **grounding**.

Specific shades


green + brown
naturally


olive + caramel
earthily


sage + beige
softly


bottle green + chocolate
deeply


mint + sand
freshly

In practice

Wooden furniture and plants. Olive and brown textiles.

Watch out

Too much brown and dark green can feel **heavy**.

Green + white

How it feels

Freshness and clarity. White gives green space and purity. Green stands out next to it.

When it suits

When you want to **breathe** and have room around you.

Specific shades


green + white
freshly


sage + cream
gently


bottle green + white
elegantly


grass green + snow
springlike


olive + linen
naturally

In practice

A white kitchen with herbs. A white shirt and green trousers.

Watch out

A too sterile white and a cold green side by side can feel **like a hospital**.

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Green + black

How it feels

Depth and elegance. Black raises contrast. Green next to it looks dark and dramatic, like an emerald in a jeweller's or a bottle of dark glass.

When it suits

When you want **a dignified, strong** impression.

Specific shades

- green + black — *strongly*
- bottle green + charcoal — *deeply*
- blue-green + black — *dramatically*
- grass green + graphite — *contrastingly*
- olive + black — *earthily*

In practice

Black accessories and an emerald colour. A dark green wall and black furniture.

Watch out

When there is too much, it can feel **heavy**.

Green + gold

How it feels

Leaves and shine. Green calms gold and gold gives green a festive air. Together they feel classic and natural.

When it suits

When you want **natural elegance**.

Specific shades

- green + gold — *naturally*
- bottle green + antique gold — *woodland-like*
- mint + champagne — *classically*
- emerald + deep gold — *strikingly*
- sage + matt gold — *quietly*

In practice

Bottle green and a gold detail. A green plant in a gold pot.

Watch out

A sharp green next to gold feels loud. **Mute** the greenery.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **soften** green, add **white**, **cream**, **sage** or **grey**.
- When you want to **ground** it, add **brown**, **olive** or **natural materials**.
- When you want to **emphasise** it, add **red**, **coral**, **purple** or **black**.
- When you want to **cool** it, **blue**, **turquoise** or **grey** will help.

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